

Verification of Functional Programs

Analysis of Algorithms

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Introduction

Preliminaries

Textbook

Tobias Nipkow ([2025] 2026). Functional Data Structures and Algorithms.

Convention

The numbers and page numbers assigned to chapters, examples, exercises, figures, quotes, sections and theorems on these slides correspond to the numbers assigned in the textbook.

Analysis of Algorithms

Description

The **computational complexity** of an **algorithm/problem** is the amount of resources (e.g. time, space, energy) required to **execute/solve** it.

Description

The **analysis of algorithms**—term coined by Donald Knuth—is the study of the computational complexity of **algorithms**. A classical book is (Cormen, Leiserson, Rivest and Stein [1990] 2022).

Description

The **computational complexity theory** is the study of the computational complexity of **problems**. A classical book is (Garey and Johnson 1979).

Analysis of Algorithms

Relation between analysis of algorithms and computational complexity theory

*“The [computational] complexity of an algorithm is always an upper bound on the [computational] complexity of the problem solved by this algorithm.”
(Wikipedia, Computational complexity, 2026-03-16).*

Analysis of Algorithms

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- (i) Where do the algorithms run? In a theoretical computer, i.e., we are interested in **machine-independent** algorithms.
- (ii) Which complexity are we interested? We are interested in **asymptotic complexity**, i.e., we are interested in the behaviour of the algorithm for **large** values of the input.

Analysis of Algorithms

The running time function

If the running time of an algorithm depends of the input then it **usually** means it depends of the **size** of the input.

We shall use a function

$$T(n) : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{\geq 0}$$

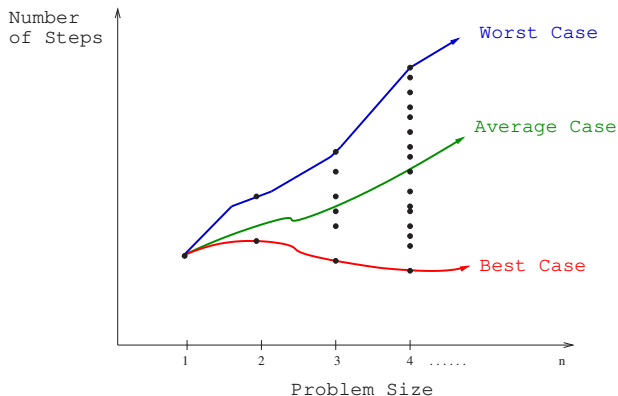
which will denote the running time of an algorithm on inputs of size n .

Asymptotic Notations

Complexity Functions

Complexity functions

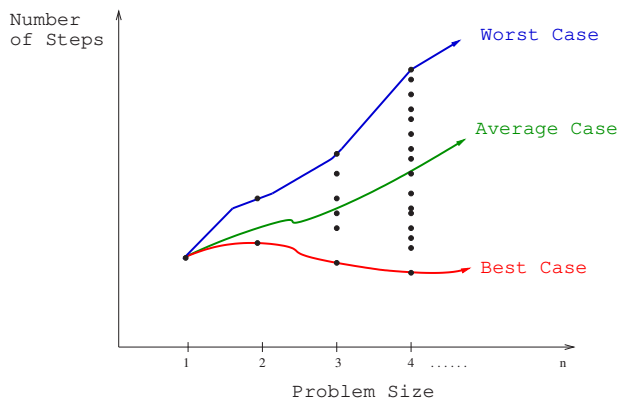
Given an input of size n we can think in three complexity functions: **best-case complexity**, **worst-case complexity** and **average-case complexity**.



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Given an input of size n we can think in three complexity functions: **best-case complexity**, **worst-case complexity** and **average-case complexity**.[†]



[†]Figure from Skiena ([1997] 2020, Fig. 2.1).

Asymptotic Notation: Big O

Definition

Let $g : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{\geq 0}$ be a function. We define the **set** of functions **big O of $g(n)$** , denoted $O(g(n))$, by

$$O(g(n)) := \{ f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{\geq 0} \mid \text{there exist positive constants } c \in \mathbb{R}^+ \\ \text{and } n_0 \in \mathbb{Z}^+ \text{ such that } f(n) \leq cg(n) \\ \text{for all } n \geq n_0 \}.$$

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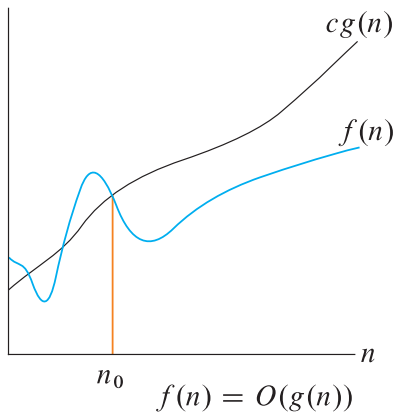
Notation

That $f(n) \in O(g(n))$ is sometimes denoted by $f(n) = O(g(n))$.

Asymptotic Notation: Big O

Remark

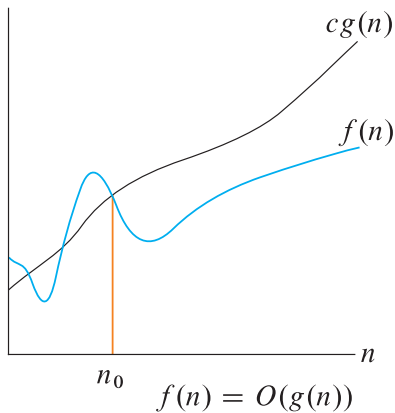
If $f(n) \in O(g(n))$ then function $g(n)$ is an **upper bound** on the growth rate of the function $f(n)$.



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[†]Figure from Cormen, Leiserson, Rivest and Stein ([1990] 2022, Fig. 3.1a).

Asymptotic Notation: Big Ω

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Let $g : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{\geq 0}$ be a function. We define the **set** of functions **big Ω of $g(n)$** , denoted $\Omega(g(n))$, by

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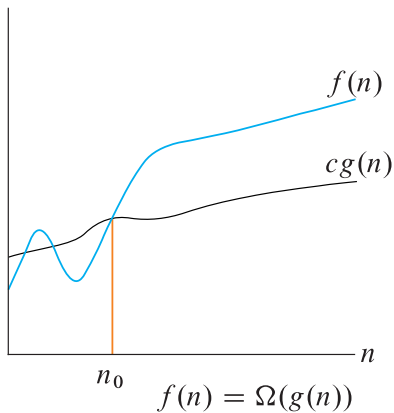
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That $f(n) \in \Omega(g(n))$ is sometimes denoted by $f(n) = \Omega(g(n))$.

Asymptotic Notation: Big Ω

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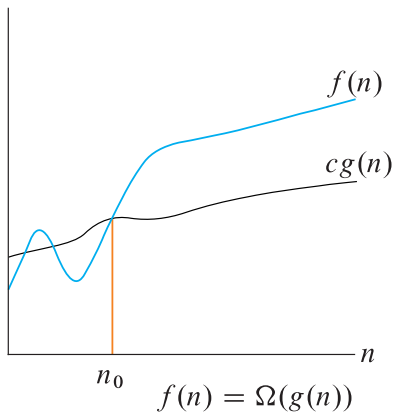
If $f(n) \in \Omega(g(n))$ then function $g(n)$ is a **lower bound** on the growth rate of the function $f(n)$.



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If $f(n) \in \Omega(g(n))$ then function $g(n)$ is a **lower bound** on the growth rate of the function $f(n)$.[†]



[†]Figure from Cormen, Leiserson, Rivest and Stein ([1990] 2022, Fig. 3.1b).

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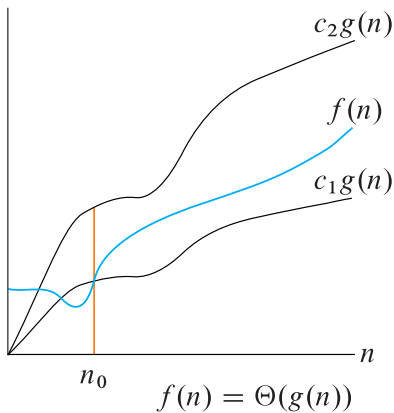
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That $f(n) \in \Theta(g(n))$ is sometimes denoted by $f(n) = \Theta(g(n))$.

Asymptotic Notation: Big Θ

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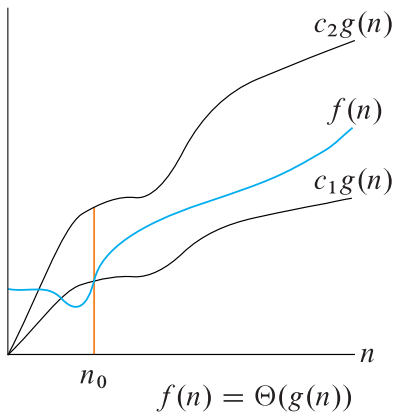
If $f(n) \in \Theta(g(n))$ then function $g(n)$ is a **lower bound** and an **upper bound** on the growth rate of the function $f(n)$.



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If $f(n) \in \Theta(g(n))$ then function $g(n)$ is a **lower bound** and an **upper bound** on the growth rate of the function $f(n)$.[†]



[†]Figure from Cormen, Leiserson, Rivest and Stein ([1990] 2022, Fig. 3.1c).

The Tyranny of Growth Rate

The Tyranny of Growth Rate

Growing rates of some functions

Each operation takes one nanosecond (10^{-9} seconds).

$n/T(n)$	$\lg n$	n	$n \lg n$	n^2	2^n	$n!$
10	0.003 μs	0.01 μs	0.033 μs	0.1 μs	1 μs	3.63 ms
20	0.004 μs	0.02 μs	0.086 μs	0.4 μs	1 ms	77.1 yrs
30	0.005 μs	0.03 μs	0.147 μs	0.9 μs	1 sec	8.4×10^{15} yrs
40	0.005 μs	0.04 μs	0.213 μs	1.6 μs	18.3 min	
50	0.006 μs	0.05 μs	0.282 μs	2.5 μs	13 days	
100	0.007 μs	0.1 μs	0.644 μs	10 μs	4×10^{13} yrs	
1,000	0.010 μs	1 μs	9.966 μs	1 ms		
10,000	0.013 μs	10 μs	130 μs	100 ms		
100,000	0.017 μs	0.10 ms	1.67 ms	10 sec		
1,000,000	0.020 μs	1 ms	19.93 ms	16.7 min		
10,000,000	0.023 μs	0.01 sec	0.23 sec	1.16 days		
100,000,000	0.027 μs	0.10 sec	2.66 sec	115.7 days		
1,000,000,000	0.030 μs	1 sec	29.90 sec	31.7 yrs		

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[†]Table adapted from (Skiena [1997] 2020, Fig. 2.2).

The Tyranny of Growth Rate

Supercomputers

Machines from: www.top500.org (last updated: March 2026)

PetaFLOP (PFLOP): 10^{15} floating-point operations per second

Date	Machine	PFLOPs
2026-11	El Capitan	1,809.00
2020-06	Fugaku	415.53
2019-06	Summit	148.60
2018-11	Summit	143.50
2018-06	Summit	122.30
2016-06	Sunway TaihuLight	93.01
2013-06	Tianhe-2	33.86
2012-06	Blue Gene/Q	16.32
2011-06	K computer	8.16

The Tyranny of Growth Rate

Example (3-SAT problem)

A **literal** is an atomic formula (propositional variable) or the negation of an atomic formula.

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A (propositional logic) formula F is in **conjunctive normal form** iff

$$F \text{ has the form } F_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge F_n,$$

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3-SAT problem: To determine the satisfiability of a propositional formula in conjunctive normal form where each disjunction of literals is limited to at most three literals.

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The problem was proposed in Karp's 21 NP-complete problems (Karp 1972).

The Tyranny of Growth Rate

Example (improvements on the time complexity of 3-SAT deterministic algorithmic)

$O(1.32793^n)$ Liu (2018)

$O(1.3303^n)$ Makino, Tamaki and Yamamoto (2011) and Makino, Tamaki and Yamamoto (2013)

$O(1.3334^n)$ Moser and Scheder (2011)

$O(1.439^n)$ Kutzkov and Scheder (2010)

$O(1.465^n)$ Scheder (2008)

$O(1.473^n)$ Brueggemann and Kern (2004)

$O(1.481^n)$ Dantsin, Goerdts, Hirsch, Kannan, Kleinberg, Papadimitriou, Raghavan and Schöning (2002)

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[†]Main sources: Hertli (2011) and Hertli (2015). Last updated: March 2026.

The Tyranny of Growth Rate

Example (continuation)

$O(1.497^n)$ Schiermeyer (1996)

$O(1.505^n)$ Kullmann (1999)

$O(1.6181^n)$ Monien and Speckenmeyer (1979) and Monien and Speckenmeyer (1985)

$O(2^n)$ Brute-force search

The Tyranny of Growth Rate

Example (3-SAT simulation)

Running 3-SAT times on different supercomputers using the faster deterministic algorithm, i.e. $T(n) = 1.32793^n$.

Date	Machine	PFLOPs	$n = 150$	$n = 200$	$n = 400$
2025-11	El Capitan	1,809.00	1.7 sec	27.6 days	3.2×10^{23} yrs
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2019-06	Summit	148.60	20.1 sec	336.1 days	4.0×10^{24} yrs
2018-11	Summit	143.50	20.8 sec	348.1 days	4.1×10^{24} yrs
2018-06	Summit	122.30	24.5 sec	1.1 yrs	4.8×10^{24} yrs
2016-06	Sunway TaihuLight	93.01	32.2 sec	1.5 yrs	6.4×10^{24} yrs
2013-06	Tianhe-2	33.86	1.5 min	4.1 yrs	1.7×10^{25} yrs
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1.3334^n	3.1 sec	62.8 days	1.7×10^{24} yrs
1.439^n	3.3 days	7.2×10^5 yrs	2.9×10^{37} yrs
1.465^n	48.0 days	2.6×10^7 yrs	3.8×10^{40} yrs
2^n	2.5×10^{19} yrs	2.8×10^{34} yrs	4.5×10^{94} yrs

Running Time Function in Isabelle/HOL

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Description

Given a function $f : \sigma_1 \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow \sigma_n \rightarrow \tau$ we define a **running time function**

$T_f : \sigma_1 \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow \sigma_n \rightarrow \text{Nat}$ by

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{E}[f \ p_1 \dots p_n = e] &= (T_f \ p_1 \dots p_n = \mathcal{T}[e] + 1), \\ \mathcal{T}[f \ e_1 \dots e_n] &= \mathcal{T}[e_1] + \cdots + \mathcal{T}[e_n] + T_f \ e_1 \dots e_n,\end{aligned}$$

where “ $\mathcal{E}[\cdot]$ translates defining equations for f to defining equations for T_f and $\mathcal{T}[\cdot]$ translates expressions that compute some value to expressions that computes the number of function calls” (p. 6).

Running Time Function in Isabelle/HOL

Example

We calculate the running time function T_{app} for the function `app` defined by

`app : List A  $\rightarrow$  List A  $\rightarrow$  List A`

`app nil ys = ys`

`app (cons x xs) ys = cons x (app xs ys)`

(continued on next slide)

Running Time Function in Isabelle/HOL

Example (continuation)

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{E}[\text{app nil } ys = ys] \\ &= (T_{\text{app}} \text{ nil } ys = \mathcal{T}[\![ys]\!] + 1) \\ &= (T_{\text{app}} \text{ nil } ys = 1) \qquad (\mathcal{T}[\![ys]\!] = 0)\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{E}[\text{app (cons } x \text{ } xs) \text{ } ys = \text{cons } x \text{ (app } xs \text{ } ys)] \\ &= (T_{\text{app}} (\text{cons } x \text{ } xs) \text{ } ys = \mathcal{T}[\![\text{cons } x \text{ (app } xs \text{ } ys)]\!] + 1)\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{T}[\![\text{cons } x \text{ (app } xs \text{ } ys)]\!] \\ &= \mathcal{T}[\![x]\!] + \mathcal{T}[\![\text{app } xs \text{ } ys]\!] + T_{\text{cons}} x (\text{app } xs \text{ } ys) \\ &= \mathcal{T}[\![xs]\!] + \mathcal{T}[\![ys]\!] + T_{\text{app}} xs \text{ } ys \qquad (\mathcal{T}[\![x]\!] = T_{\text{cons}} x (\text{app } xs \text{ } ys) = 0) \\ &= T_{\text{app}} xs \text{ } ys \qquad (\mathcal{T}[\![xs]\!] = \mathcal{T}[\![ys]\!] = 0)\end{aligned}$$

(continued on next slide)

Example (continuation)

From the previous equations we have

$$T_{\text{app}} : \text{List } A \rightarrow \text{List } A \rightarrow \text{Nat}$$

$$T_{\text{app}} \text{ nil } ys = 1$$

$$T_{\text{app}} (\text{cons } x \text{ xs}) \text{ ys} = T_{\text{app}} \text{ xs } \text{ ys} + 1$$

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